

# Psalms 24

*The Earth Is the Lord's*

The earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof  
KJV · Standalone study handout

## 1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *The earth is the LORD'S, and the fulness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.*
- 2 *For he hath founded it upon the seas, and established it upon the floods.*
- 3 *Who shall ascend into the hill of the LORD? or who shall stand in his holy place?*
- 4 *He that hath clean hands, and a pure heart; who hath not lifted up his soul unto vanity, nor sworn deceitfully.*
- 5 *He shall receive the blessing from the LORD, and righteousness from the God of his salvation.*
- 6 *This is the generation of them that seek him, that seek thy face, O Jacob. Selah.*
- 7 *Lift up your heads, O ye gates; and be ye lift up, ye everlasting doors; and the King of glory shall come in.*
- 8 *Who is this King of glory? The LORD strong and mighty, the LORD mighty in battle.*
- 9 *Lift up your heads, O ye gates; even lift them up, ye everlasting doors; and the King of glory shall come in.*
- 10 *Who is this King of glory? The LORD of hosts, he is the King of glory. Selah.*

## 2 · CONTEXT

Psalms 24 likely accompanied a procession bringing the ark into Jerusalem, moving from a cosmic claim of God's ownership of all creation, to an entrance liturgy asking who may ascend God's holy hill, to a triumphant call for the King of glory to enter the gates. Henry connects the psalm's three movements—creation, character, coronation—as a unified vision of the God who owns everything, requires clean hands and a pure heart for access to His presence, and comes as a victorious King worthy of the grandest welcome.

## 3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

*The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.*

### Verse 1-2

Total divine ownership: the earth and its fulness, the world and its inhabitants, belong to the Lord, who founded it upon the seas and established it upon the floods—creation's ownership rests on God's creative and sustaining power.

### Verse 3-6

The entrance question—who may ascend the Lord's hill and stand in His holy place—is answered with clean hands, a pure heart, no vanity or falsehood in life, receiving blessing and righteousness from God; such a generation is called those who “seek” His face.

### Verse 7-10

A jubilant call-and-response at the gates: “Lift up your heads, O ye gates... that the King of glory may come in.” The identity of this King is pressed twice—“the Lord strong and mighty... the Lord of hosts”—celebrating His triumphant entrance with full honor.

## 4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

### Meaning.

Because God owns everything, access to His presence rightly requires purity of heart and hands, and He deserves to be welcomed as the triumphant King of glory in every sphere He enters.

### Application for life today.

Let the reminder that “the earth is the Lord's” reshape your sense of ownership over possessions, achievements, or even relationships—hold them as stewardship, not entitlement. Take the entrance requirements of verses 3–6 seriously as an examen for approaching worship, not a mere ritual question. And practically “lift up the gates” of your own life—home, work, plans—inviting the King of glory into areas you might otherwise keep closed off.

## 5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

*Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.*

1. Where do you need to remember that something you treat as “yours” actually belongs to the Lord?

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2. How do your “clean hands and pure heart” look right now, honestly, in light of verses 3–4?

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3. What area of your life most needs you to “lift up the gates” and welcome the King of glory in?

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Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Group / Church: \_\_\_\_\_

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).